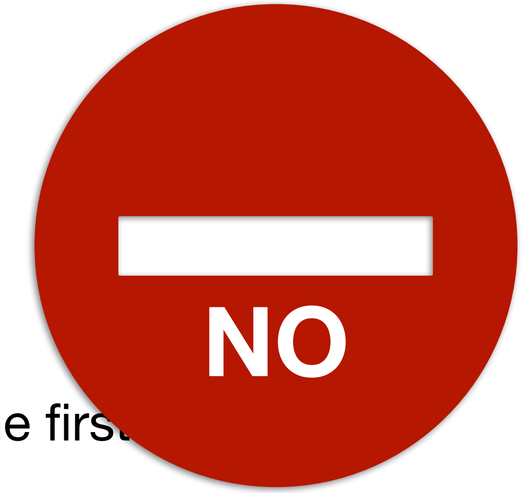
The Moog

Modular analog synthesizer



- The Moog modular analog synthesizer, developed in the early 1960s, was the firs
  rivaled the power of the electric guitar in volume and timbre.
- The Moog is an analog modular synthesizer, meaning that the sounds were generated from a sound wave oscillator—a physical (analog) device, controlled, in a physical sense, by voltage.
- To produce different sounds on the Moog, one needed different modules that would further generate or modify sounds.
- Sounds were created using quarter-inch cables to “patch” modules together (this is the etymology of the term “patch,” which today refers to any sound or preset on a synthesizer).
- The resulting collection of modules was typically bigger than the keyboard itself.
- The size alone meant the Moog could not be taken on the road: this early synthesizer, not unlike the early computers, was a massive device that was prohibitively expensive for most musicians.

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Modular analog synthesizer

- Developed in the early 1960s
- Analog sound wave oscillators controlled by voltage
- Different modules generate or modify sounds, “patched” together with quarter-inch cables
- Massive and prohibitively expensive